

Lawhive · Hackathon 2026



CASE BRIEF / MESSY, MILD

CASE 06

MY OLD EMPLOYER WON'T PAY WHAT THEY OWE ME

V. 01

LONDON 30/05/26

MESSY, MILD



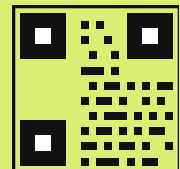
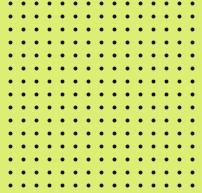
CLAIMANT

Ryan Daniel Patel

27



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My old employer won't pay what they owe me

Ryan Daniel Patel, 27

PROBLEM, IN THE CLIENT'S OWN WORDS

I left my job at a marketing agency five weeks ago. I worked my full four-week notice period and left on good terms, or so I thought.

My final pay was supposed to include my last month's wages (about £2,800 before tax), 8 days of holiday I hadn't taken (roughly £1,050 before tax), and a commission payment of about £1,500 that my manager confirmed in an email before I left.

I've received nothing. Not a payslip, not a penny.

I emailed HR the day after the payment was due and they said 'we're looking into it'. I emailed again two weeks later, no reply. I sent a third email last week saying I'd take further action if I wasn't paid within seven days. I also messaged my old manager directly who said 'nothing I can do, it's with finance'. That deadline was yesterday and still nothing.

I haven't raised a formal grievance or sent any kind of legal letter, I'm not really sure what the process is. I'm also worried about the commission because there's a clause in my contract that says it's 'payable at the company's discretion on active employees'. Does that mean they can just refuse to pay it even though it was confirmed?

KEY INFORMATION

Client	Ryan Daniel Patel
Former employer	Greycliff Digital (marketing agency)
Notice period worked	Four weeks, departed five weeks ago
Outstanding wages	Approximately £2,800 gross
Outstanding holiday pay	8 days, approximately £1,050 gross
Disputed commission	£1,500 (confirmed by manager in email)

DOCUMENTS PROVIDED

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
01	employment_contract.pdf	Contract with salary, notice period, holiday entitlement, and commission clause stating commission is 'payable at the company's discretion on active employees at the date of payment'.
02	commission_confirmation_email.pdf	Email from Ryan's line manager two weeks before his departure confirming £1,500 commission for Q4, 'will be included in your final pay'.
03	email_1_to_hr.pdf	Ryan's first email to HR the day after the missed pay date.

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
04	hr_reply.pdf	HR's reply: 'Thanks for flagging this Ryan, we're looking into it and will get back to you'. No follow-up was ever sent.
05	email_2_to_hr.pdf	Second email to HR two weeks later, more firmly requesting payment. No reply received.
06	message_to_manager.png	Screenshot of message to former line manager and reply: 'Sorry mate, nothing I can do, it's with finance'.
07	email_3_to_hr.pdf	Third email warning of 'further action' if not paid within seven days. No reply received.
08	recent_payslips.pdf	Last three payslips showing normal monthly salary of £2,800 gross and two previous commission payments at similar amounts.